

Half of our rainforests have been chopped down in the last century.

Overgrazing

The main cause of desertification is overgrazing. Too many animals grazing and trampling on plants can lead to soils becoming bare. The wind then blows or the rain washes the bare soil away.

Deforestation

Trees are chopped down for fuel, to make things with, and to clear land for farming. If too many trees are chopped down without new ones being planted, this leaves bare soil with no tree roots to hold the soil in place.

Wood is used to make paper.

Loose soil can be washed or blown away.

Only a few types of plants can grow in desertified land.

SOIL TO SAND

People's actions are causing healthy soil to lose its nutrients and turn into loose, dry sand. This process is called desertification. It is bad news for us and for the environment.

Dry land has few plants, which many animals need to feed on.